



ELIAS EL SOUS

DUBAI, UAE | 21 NOVEMBER, 1991

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/elias-el-sous



PERSONAL PROFILE

Driven by a passion for hospitality and provided with over a decade of experience in the industry, I thrive in delivering exceptional guest experiences.

As a forward-thinking professional, I continuously seek out opportunities to enhance guest satisfaction, employee engagement, and profitability, allowing me to consistently exceed expectations and drive business growth.

EDUCATION

Lebanese University

Bachelor Degree in
Hospitality Management

LANGUAGES

- **Arabic** fluent
- **English** fluent
- **French** fluent
- **Spanish** beginner

AWARDS

Hilton Circle of Excellence 2019
Hotelier Middle East 30 Under 30

WORK EXPERIENCE

Head of Sales

SEP 2024 - PRESENT

Al Khoory Hotels Group

- Managing seven properties with a total of almost 1,200 keys across the city of Dubai.
- Overseeing leisure sales, corporate sales, events, and catering operations to maximize revenue across all segments.
- Leading and inspiring the sales department to consistently exceed ambitious revenue targets and drive sustainable, long-term business growth.
- Developing and executing comprehensive sales strategies aligned with the company's broader business objectives.
- Managing and mentoring a high-performing sales team, focusing on development, motivation, and retention.
- Building and maintaining strong, trusted, and long-term relationships with key clients, partners, and strategic accounts.
- Analyzing market trends and competitor activities to proactively adapt strategies and maintain competitive advantage.
- Identifying new business opportunities, partnerships, and market segments to expand market share.
- Representing the company at ITB Berlin, Arabian Travel Market Dubai, and other major industry events, trade shows, and client meetings to promote brand presence and drive business growth.

General Manager

FEB 2023 - JUL 2024

The Muse - Dubai

- Oversee the operational, commercial and financial functions of the property.
- Ensure compliance to the operating controls, SOP's, policies, procedures and standards.
- Maximizing room revenue through innovative sales practices and yield management.
- Responsible for the preparation, presentation and subsequent achievement of the operating budget and commercial plan.
- Manage on-going profitability of the properties, ensuring revenue and guest satisfaction targets are met and exceeded.
- Responsible of the P&L statement and the ability to react with impactful strategies.
- Developing improvement actions, carry out costs savings.
- Prepare a monthly financial reporting for the owners and stake holders.
- Assisting in the procurement of operating supplies and equipment, and contracting with third-party vendors for essential requirements and services.
- Responsible of the recruitment, management and development of team members.
- Overseeing and managing all departments and working closely with department heads.
- Provide effective leadership to the team members and head of departments.
- Handling complaints, and oversee the service recovery procedures.
- Responsible for legalization, health & safety, fire regulations and other legal requirements.
- Responsible for safeguarding the quality of operations both internal & external audits.



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SKILLS

- Exceptional communication and networking skills
- Strong operational experience
- Successfully leading, coaching and inspiring a team
- Strong analytical and numerical skills
- Excellent listening, negotiation and presentation skills
- Strong stakeholders management
- The ability to work under pressure and multi-tasking
- Excellent organizational skills
- The ability to prepare and execute commercial strategies

TRAININGS

- Elevator Graduate Program
- Elevate 3 Program
- RMCC Revenue Management Development Program
- LEAD 2.1 Program
- One Million Arab Coders App Development

SOCIAL ACTIVITIES

Sesobel | Anta Akhi

WORK EXPERIENCE

Cluster Director of Sales

JAN 2021 - OCT 2022

Hilton Worldwide

- Handling the Sales Department for 5 properties in Dubai including a pre-opening hotel.
- Directly accountable for driving the top line budget and forecast by implementing a commercial strategy using the Commercial Focus process and all available business tools.
- Deliver the budgeted revenues across all revenue streams, to include but not limited; All Rooms, GC&E, F&B, with a control on cost of sale and marketing opportunities.
- Actively involved in budget preparation and business forecasting.
- Work with the General Managers and Commercial Director to ensure profits are maximized from each revenue stream.
- Manage, lead and train the Sales and Groups, Conferences and Events team members.
- Working with the F&B leader to develop and achieve F&B strategy and revenue.
- Ensure Business Review Guidelines, all Pricing & Rate Quotation Strategies are in place in order to maximize all pricing components and achieve the market share.
- Support various On Property, RDOS's, and Area Marketing teams in coordinating hotel level marketing, sales and public relations activities. Liaise with regional support and brand teams to provide maximum benefit to hotel performance.
- Support in establishing an optimal business mix, review and validate forecasts, develop strategies for different demand periods, and review and approve retail and group pricing.
- Creation & delivery of a creative marketing plan that help establish the hotel in the market.
- Keeps in touch with Market trends and review/amend strategies accordingly.

Assistant Director of Sales | In-charge

FEB 2020 - JAN 2021

DoubleTree by Hilton Dubai - Business Bay

- Establish and implement a structure for all sales operations, including leading the sales team, short-and-long-term market strategy, budgeting, forecasting.
- Handling all sales processes that include finding prospects, qualifying them, and defining objectives, demonstrating our solutions, creating proposals and closing deals.
- Implementing strategy to increase revenue and to forecast annual, quarterly and monthly.
- Define and achieve assigned sales targets through developing business with existing customers and new customers.
- Retain and develop existing accounts by presenting new solutions and services to clients.
- Understand and appreciate market trends, competitive landscape and industry development.
- Maintain contact with all clients in the market to ensure high levels of client satisfaction.
- Collaborates with Top Management to develop sales strategies to improve market share.
- Preparing the weekly Business Focus Meeting & Monthly Commercial Focus Meeting.
- Preparing & attending the monthly Owners Meeting and highlighting sales performance.
- Working closely with Marketing team in order to launch sales campaigns and prepare sales collaterals.



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WORK EXPERIENCE

Sales Manager | GC&E Sales Manager

FEB 2018 - JAN 2020

DoubleTree by Hilton Dubai - Business Bay

- Managing Corporate Sales and Group, Conference, and Event Sales.
- Building strong relationships with key contacts, monitoring key accounts productivity.
- Executing sales calls, cold calling and other sales techniques to increase the production from existing and new accounts
- Review business plans, identify gaps and ensure proactive efforts to fill capacity and meet set targets and budgets.
- Contribute to the selling strategy of the hotel, and manage the departments' adherence to achieving that strategy.
- Understand the competitive market place and implement approaches to ensure the hotel stays ahead in the local market.
- Identify potential new business opportunities and continuously target new accounts.
- Ensure the Group, Conference, and Events (GC&E) Sales Team Members are developed effectively and generate a culture of high quality standards for relationship building, customer service, selling techniques, and billing and processing contracts.
- Had an active presence in the community both locally and nationally, engaging with key stakeholders in the market
- Attending travel roadshows and exhibitions, promoting and featuring the property.

Food & Beverage Assistant Manager | In-charge

DEC 2016 - JAN 2018

DoubleTree by Hilton Dubai - Business Bay (pre-opening)

- Manage all F&B operations within budgeted guidelines and to the highest standards.
- Develop F&B vision, mission as well as outlets concepts.
- Design exceptional menus, purchase goods and continuously make necessary improvements.
- Executing Menu Engineering Strategy and always work with the Culinary Team in improving our products and increase sales.
- Preserve excellent levels of internal and external customer service.
- Identify customers needs and respond proactively to all of their concerns.
- Leading the F&B team by attracting the right talent, recruiting, training and appraising talented personnel.
- Establish departmental targets and objectives, KPIs, schedules, policies and procedures.
- Drive sales to maximize budgeted revenue.
- Evaluate guest satisfaction levels with a focus on continuous improvement.
- Ensure communication meetings are conducted.
- Working closely with the marketing team and insuring proper launch of F&B campaign through online presence and offline collaterals.
- Comply with security and health & safety regulations.
- Assist other departments wherever necessary and maintain good working relationship.
- Manage the banqueting department and introduced Outside Catering service as new product to maximize revenue.

Elevator Trainee

SEP 2014 - AUG 2016

General Manager Development Program

Hilton Dubai Jumeirah | Hilton Dubai The Walk

Waldorf Astoria Dubai Palm Jumeirah

Receptionist | Night Auditor

APR 2013 - SEP 2014

Rotana Tamar Hotel Beirut

Food & Beverage Intern

APR 2012 - SEP 2012

InterContinental Phoenicia Beirut, an IHG Hotel